Oliver Searle-Barnes

Hands-on full-stack engineer

Staff Engineer, Tech Lead, Architect

22 years experience

FnCasts - watch me code on youtube

opsb - 200+ repos

opsb - 14 communities

opsb - top 1%

ollysb

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INTRODUCTION

Building software that people actually love to use is what gets me going. With 22 years experience I've delivered successful products for the AI, Fintech, SaaS, Telecoms, Retail, Publishing, Energy, Charity, Health and Beauty, and Domestic appliance sectors.

I've led teams building computer vision training pipelines at TwentyBN, Open Banking integration across UK high street banks at CompareTheMarket, IoT cloud services for commercial robot vacuums at Vorwerk, an event-sourced real-time community platform at Zapnito, and a WebDAV-based CMS that let Informa's journalists edit articles directly in Microsoft Word.

Most recently founding engineer at xpflow; previously co-founded a school e-commerce business later taken in-house by Marks & Spencer.

Agile from day one; comfortable owning the engineering function or contributing within an established team.

SKILLS

Backend

- Elixir / Phoenix 8
- Ruby on Rails 8
- NextJS 3
- SQL 22
- Java 8

Datastores

- Postgres 20
- Redis 15
- Snowflake 2
- Firebase 4

AI

- OpenAI API 1
- AI agents 1
- LangChain / LangSmith 1
- Agentic coding 1

Frontend

- React 10
- Typescript/Javascript 17
- Elm 5
- HTML / CSS / SASS 22

Infrastructure

- AWS 14
- Terraform 4

Methodology

- Scrum / Kanban 20
- BDD / TDD 18

Leadership

- Team leadership & hiring 15
- Technical strategy & architecture 20
- Product discovery & delivery 10
- Zero-to-one shipping 15

OPEN SOURCE

fncasts / fnchess

Paired with a friend on youtube to build a chess game in Elm backend by Phoenix-Channels for realtime. See **https://fncasts.io** for the episodes.

orbitjs / orbit

A javascript library for orchestrating data synchronization. See **http://orbitjs.com** for more information.

saschatimme / elm-phoenix

Integration between Elm and Phoenix channels

opsb / cv-elm

The code used to generate the CV you're reading right now

COMMUNITY

A regular at Elixir meetups in Barcelona, London, and Berlin, and active in the Elixir and Elm slacks. Previously ran the Elm hack night in Barcelona. I've found both communities friendly and helpful.

EDUCATION

Artificial Intelligence — **2/1**

Sussex University — 2001-2004

EXPERIENCE

xpflow
Founding Engineer
Feb 2025-Apr 2026
Dallas / Remote

Alfie (AI affiliate recruitment)
Built Alfie, AI agent scouts that autonomously discover, evaluate, and reach out to affiliate partners, learning user preferences. Shipped MVP in three weeks and validated strong demand. On-demand scale limits informed the company's next phase: building the world's largest affiliate database.
AI/LLMs, NextJS, Postgres

Tree3
Tech Lead
Jan 2024-Feb 2025
Dallas / Remote

XP Affiliate Platform
Led engineering on a high-performance affiliate platform. When the product stalled, ran customer discovery and proposed an AI-powered affiliate recruitment product, spun out as xpflow with me on the founding team.
NextJS, Postgres, Redis

Tastermonial
Interim CTO
Jul 2023-Dec 2023
Cupertino / Remote

Tastermonial App
Replaced MVP with a high-performance Flutter/Phoenix mobile app, running on AWS with supporting build pipelines.
Elixir, Flutter, Sqlite, Postgres, AWS/Terraform

Boulevard
Senior Engineer
Oct 2021-Jun 2023
Los Angeles / Remote

API and Platform Services
Joined the API team at this health and beauty unicorn to scale platform services and integrations with 3rd party services.
Elixir, Postgres, React, Typescript, AWS/Terraform

Vorwerk
Tech Lead
Apr 2021-Sep 2021
Wuppertal / Remote

Kobold
Bootstrapped an Elixir/Phoenix team at this global consumer appliance giant to provide cloud services and a Python client for a new line of commercial robot vacuum cleaners.
Elixir, Python, Postgres, AWS/Terraform

CompareTheMarket.com
Senior Engineer
Feb 2019-Apr 2021
London / Remote

MoneyHub
Rebuilt Bean.com as a high-performance Elixir service for this leading UK price-comparison site, integrating the majority of high street banks via Open Banking.
Elixir, GraphQL, Elm, Javascript, Ruby, Postgres, AWS

TwentyBN
Senior Engineer
Aug–Dec 2018
Berlin / Remote

Video Annotation Editor
Designed and built two Elm apps to collect video gesture training data from Amazon Mechanical Turk workers for this computer vision AI company.
Elm, Javascript

Liqid
Senior Backend Engineer
Jan–Aug 2018
Berlin / Remote

Salesforce Integration
Built an Elixir/RabbitMQ microservice to integrate this wealth management fintech's Rails app with Salesforce.
Elixir, Ruby on Rails, RabbitMQ, Salesforce, Docker, GraphQL

Zapnito
Engineering Lead
Jan 2015–Jan 2018
London / Remote

Feeds
Led the development of a white-labelled realtime community platform.
Phoenix, Phoenix-Channels, Elixir, Elm, Javascript, JWT, Auth0, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Lytbulb
CTO
2014–2015
London / Remote

lytbulb.com
Led development of a trello-like product aimed at the energy sector, focusing on oil and gas.
Ruby on Rails, Ember.js, Firebase, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Myschooldirect
CTO & Co-founder
2010–2014
London / Remote

Give4Sure
A browser plugin helping shoppers raise money for their chosen charities.
Browser extensions, Ruby on Rails, Postgres, Ember.js, Kanban, BDD

Marks and Spencer School Uniforms
An online store for schools to create their own Marks and Spencer uniforms; M&S later bought out the project and took it in-house.
Ruby on Rails, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

myschooldirect.com
A Quidco style site helpers shoppers raise money for their children's school.
Ruby on rails, Postgres, Kanban, BDD

Informa
Tech Lead / Architect
2005-2010
London

World Cellular Information Service
Led team to replace Informa Telecom's flagship product (WCIS), a mobile markets intelligence platform covering 226 countries.
Java, Spring, MS Analytics services, Oracle DB, Scrum, TDD

World Broadband Information Service
Developed a BI portal based on the Mondrian OLAP engine.
Java, Spring, OLAP, Mondrian, Oracle DB, Scrum, TDD

Intelligence Centre 2
Devised a webdav based CMS allowing Journalists to edit articles in MS Word.
Java/Spring, Oracle DB, Scrum, BDD